

Running Python Code from the Command Line with -c

If you need to run a small amount of throwaway Python code that you run once and then discard, pass the `-c` switch to `python.exe` on Windows or `python3` on macOS and Linux. The code to run should come after the `-c` switch, enclosed in double quotes. For example, enter the following into the terminal window:

```
C:\Users\Al>python -c "print('Hello, world')"  
Hello, world
```

The `-c` switch is handy when you want to see the results of a single Python instruction and don't want to waste time entering the interactive shell. For example, you could quickly display the output of the `help()` function and then return to the command line:

```
C:\Users\Al>python -c "help(len)"  
Help on built-in function len in module builtins:  
  
len(obj, /)  
    Return the number of items in a container.  
  
C:\Users\Al>
```

Running Python Programs from the Command Line

Python programs are text files that have the `.py` file extension. They're not executable files; rather, the Python interpreter reads these files and carries out the Python instructions in them. On Windows, the interpreter's executable file is `python.exe`. On macOS and Linux, it's `python3` (the original `python` file contains the Python version 2 interpreter). Running the commands `python yourScript.py` OR `python3 yourScript.py` will run the Python instructions saved in a file named `yourScript.py`.

Running the py.exe Program

On Windows, Python installs a `py.exe` program in the `C:\Windows` folder. This program is identical to `python.exe` but accepts an additional command line argument that lets you run any Python version installed on your